CENANGO

ACCOUNTING SYSTEM

Integrations plan

Connecting the app to Shopify, payment services, banks, spreadsheets and other systems, and to Claude through an MCP plugin.

The goal

Today every transaction is typed into the app by hand. The goal is for sales, payments, fees and bank transactions to come in **automatically** from the systems the company already uses, as **drafts** that a person checks and posts.

Three ways to connect

1. Import from file

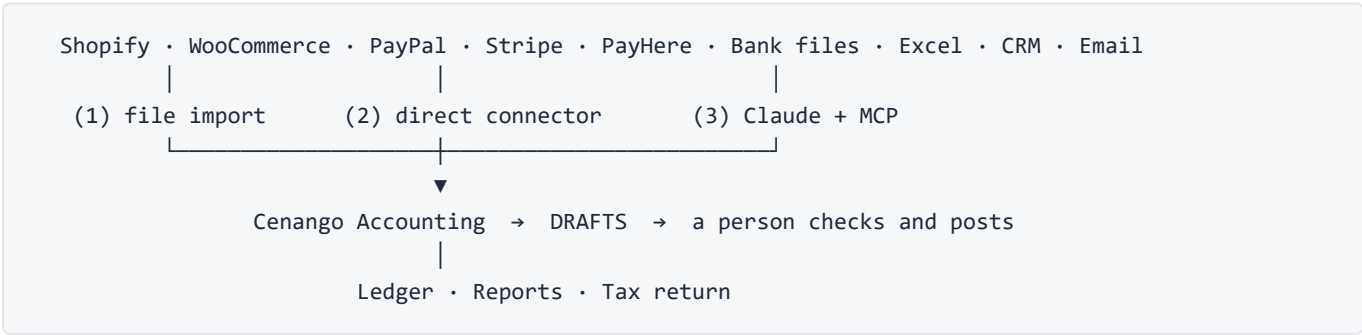
Excel / CSV from any bank, shop or system, with a column-mapping screen. Works with **everything**, fully offline.

2. Direct connectors

Built into the app for the most-used services (Shopify, WooCommerce, PayPal, Stripe, PayHere). One “Sync now” button.

3. Claude (MCP plugin)

Claude reads and drafts records through our MCP server and connects to any other service that has an MCP server or API.



Rules that never change

- **Drafts only.** Nothing imported or created by Claude reaches the ledger until a person posts it.
- **No duplicates.** Each outside record (a Shopify order, a bank line) is imported once, remembered by its own ID.
- **Everything is logged** in the Activity Log, with its source (“via Shopify”, “via Claude”, “from file”).
- **Off by default.** Each integration is switched on by an administrator. Keys are stored encrypted and can be removed at any time.
- **Offline stays the default.** The internet is needed only while a connector syncs or Claude is used.

1 What can be connected

Type	Examples	What comes into the app	How
Online shops	Shopify, WooCommerce, Wix, Squarespace, Amazon, Daraz	Orders → invoices; refunds → credit notes; fees → expenses; payouts → bank	Connector · file · Claude
Payments	PayPal, Stripe, Square, PayHere, card machines	Payments received, fees, payouts to the bank	Connector · file · Claude
Banks	Statement files (CSV / Excel) from any bank	Bank lines for matching and reconciliation	File
POS / shop billing	Retail and restaurant POS systems	Daily sales totals	File · Claude
Spreadsheets	Excel, Google Sheets	Customers, vendors, opening balances, transactions	File · Claude
Email	Gmail, Outlook	Send invoices and reminders; read supplier bills	Claude
CRM	HubSpot, Zoho CRM, Salesforce	Customers; a won deal → draft invoice	Claude
Receipts	Photos / PDFs of receipts and bills	Draft expenses and bills	Claude
Couriers	Delivery services with an API	Shipping costs	File · Claude
Tax / statutory	VAT, EPF / ETF returns	Export files in the format the office accepts	Export

Shopify in detail

Shopify data	Becomes in our app	Ready today?
Orders	Invoices with lines, tax and shipping	✓
Customers	Customers, matched by email	✓
Payments and payouts	Payments; bank deposit when the payout arrives	✓
Shopify / payment fees	Expense, e.g. “Shopify fees”	✓
Refunds and returns	Credit notes	✓
Taxes per order	Mapped to our tax codes	✓
Orders in USD, EUR…	Foreign-currency invoices	✓
Discounts	Discount lines	◐ **to add**
Shipping charged	Shipping income line	◐ **to add**
Gift cards	A liability until used	◐ **to add**
Products	Products & services list	✗ **to build**
Stock and cost of goods	Inventory quantities and COGS	✗ **to build**

> About 70% of Shopify can be connected today. Products and inventory must be built first; they are also the largest gap compared with QuickBooks.

2 The phases

Phase 1 — Import from file

Version 1.1 · about 2–3 weeks · works offline · needs nothing else

- One **Import** screen: choose an Excel or CSV file, then match its columns to ours (date, description, amount, customer…). The mapping is saved per source, so next month is one click.
- Imports bank statements (for reconciliation), sales, customers, vendors and opening balances.
- Preview before import; duplicates skipped; everything lands as drafts.
- Bank lines are matched automatically to open invoices and bills, with suggestions to confirm.

Phase 2 — Products, inventory, discounts and shipping

Version 1.2 · about 3–4 weeks · needed before Shopify products and stock

- Products & services list: name, SKU, sale price, cost, income and expense accounts, tax code.
- Stock quantities, cost of goods sold per item (average cost), stock adjustments, low-stock list.
- Discount lines and shipping lines on invoices.

Phase 3 — Integrations framework and the Shopify connector

Version 1.3 · about 3 weeks · needs internet only while syncing

- **Settings** → **Integrations**: connect, disconnect, last sync, errors. Keys stored encrypted.
- **Mapping screen**: which bank receives payouts, which account gets fees, Shopify tax → our tax codes, Shopify products → our products.
- **Sync now** (and optional hourly sync): orders, refunds, payouts and fees arrive as drafts. Each Shopify ID is imported once.
- A summary after each sync: “12 orders, 1 refund, 2 payouts imported as drafts”.

Phase 4 — More connectors

Version 1.4 · about 1–2 weeks each

- Built on the same framework, in the order customers need them, for example WooCommerce, PayPal, Stripe and PayHere.

Phase 5 — Claude MCP server and plugin

Version 1.5 · about 3–4 weeks · optional for each company

- **API keys** in Settings, each tied to a user and role (a key can be read-only). Reachable from the same PC only.
- **MCP server** installed with the app. Read tools: invoices, bills, customers, reports, account activity. Draft tools: invoice, bill, journal entry. **No posting, voiding or deleting.**
- **Claude plugin** with ready-made skills: Month-end close · Import Shopify sales · Chase overdue customers · Prepare VAT return · Explain a report.
- With Shopify's (or another service's) own connector added to Claude, Claude can move data between them and our app, e.g. “Import this week's Shopify orders as draft invoices”.

Timeline

Version	Contents	Estimate
1.1	Import from file (bank, sales, lists, opening balances) with matching	2–3 weeks
1.2	Products, inventory, discount and shipping lines	3–4 weeks
1.3	Integrations framework + Shopify connector	3 weeks
1.4	Further connectors (WooCommerce, PayPal, Stripe, PayHere…)	1–2 weeks each
1.5	API keys, MCP server, Claude plugin and skills	3–4 weeks

> Estimates are rough and assume one developer working with Claude. Phases 1, 2 and 5 do not depend on each other and can be reordered.

3 Safety, privacy and what we need

Safety and privacy

- **Drafts only** from every source; a person posts. Claude can never post, void or delete.
- **Audit trail:** every imported or Claude-created record shows its source in the Activity Log and on its transaction details page.
- **Undo:** an import can be removed as a whole while its records are still drafts.
- **Keys:** Shopify, PayPal and API keys are stored encrypted, never shown again after saving, and can be revoked.
- **Privacy notice:** connectors send nothing except the requests needed to fetch data. When Claude is used, the data it reads is sent to Claude (Anthropic) to answer the question. Customers are told this clearly, and both can stay switched off.
- **Offline default:** without connectors or Claude, the app never uses the internet.

What we need to start

Item	Why
The list of services customers actually use	Decides which connectors come first (Phase 4)
A Shopify store for testing (a free development store is fine)	To build and test the Shopify connector
Sample bank statement files from the banks customers use	To test the file import
PayPal / Stripe / PayHere sandbox accounts	To test payment connectors without real money
Approval of the privacy notice wording	Before the Claude plugin is offered
A Claude account for testing the plugin	Phase 5

Decisions for management

1. Agree the order: **file import** → **products/inventory** → **Shopify** → **more connectors** → **Claude**, or move Claude earlier?
2. Which connectors come first after Shopify?
3. Should Claude start **read-only** (questions and reports only) before it is allowed to create drafts?
4. Are connectors and the Claude plugin part of the standard product, or a paid add-on?

Prepared 22 October 2026 for Cenango Accounting version 0.1.0.